

Pedestrian Traffic Fatalities by State: 2022 Preliminary Data

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GHSA REPORTS

JUNE 22, 2023

GHSA projects 7,508 people walking were killed by in motor vehicle crashes in 2022. This represents a 1% increase from 2021.

Summary

GHSA's annual Spotlight report, *Pedestrian Traffic Fatalities by State: 2022 Preliminary Data*, offers a comprehensive look at state and national trends in pedestrian deaths in 2022. The report projects that drivers struck and killed at least 7,508 people walking in 2022 – the highest number since 1981 and an average of 20 deaths every day.

GHSA previously issued a report finding that 3,434 pedestrians were killed on U.S. roadways in the first half of 2022, based on preliminary data reported by State Highway Safety Offices. A second report analyzing state-reported data for all of 2022 found that roadways continue to be incredibly deadly for pedestrians. There were 2.37 pedestrian deaths per billion vehicle miles traveled (VMT) in 2022, up yet again and continuing a troubling trend of elevated rates that began in 2020.

The report also includes an analysis of 2021 data from the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration's Fatality Analysis Reporting System to provide additional context on when, where and how drivers strike and kill people on foot. This analysis uncovered a shocking safety disparity for people walking: Pedestrian deaths rose a troubling 77% between 2010 and 2021, compared to a 25% rise in all other traffic fatalities. The data analysis was conducted by Elizabeth Petraglia, Ph.D., of research firm [Westat](#).

To combat this pedestrian safety crisis, GHSA supports a comprehensive solution based on the Safe System approach outlined in the U.S. Department of Transportation's *National Roadway Safety Strategy* (NRSS). Each of the five elements of this approach – safe road users, safe vehicles, safe speeds, safe roads and post-crash care – contribute in different but overlapping ways to provide a multi-layered safety net that can protect people on foot as well as other road users. The report includes examples of how states are utilizing Safe System principles to improve pedestrian safety.

- [Download the Report](#)
- News Release: [Drivers Hit and Killed More Than 7,500 Pedestrians Last Year, Most in 41 Years, New Projection Shows](#) (June 22, 2023)
- [Download the January - June Preliminary Report](#) (released February 2023)

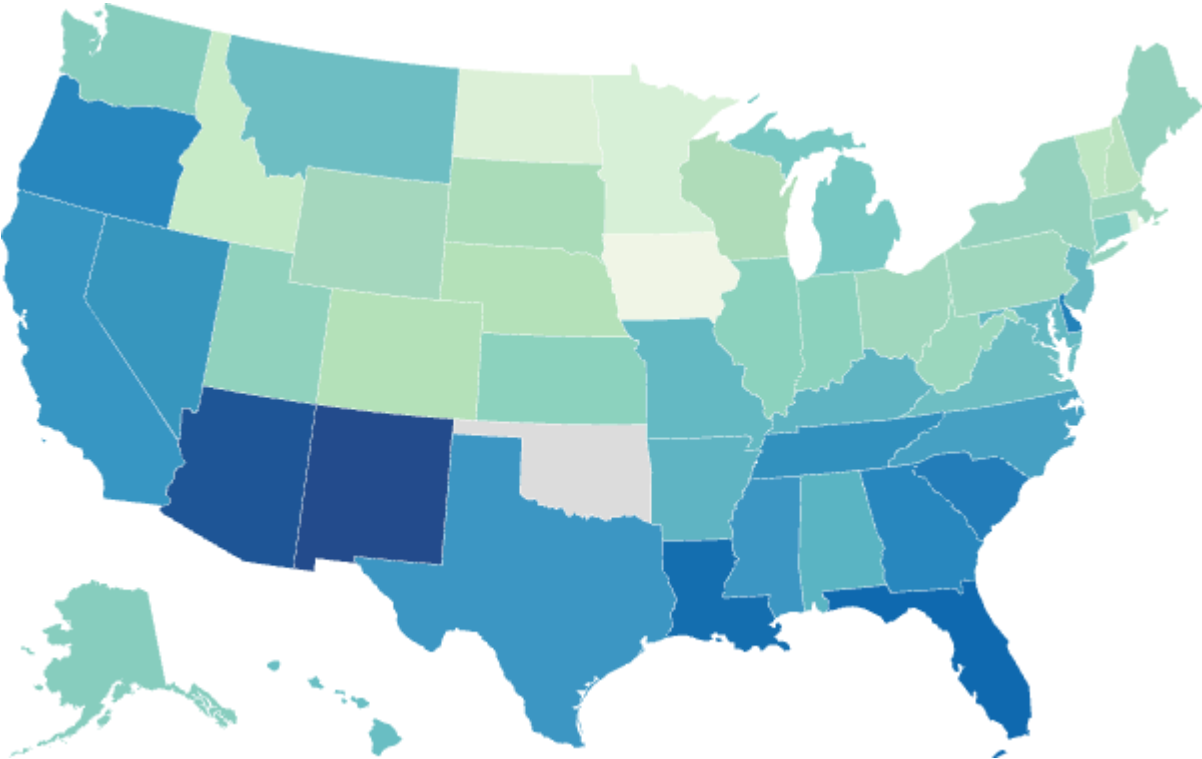
Explore the Data

U.S. Pedestrian Fatalities, 2019-2022

Deaths of people walking surged 19% in just three years

**Oklahoma excluded because complete data was not available*
Source: Governors Highway Safety Association (GHSA) • [Embed](#)

U.S. Pedestrian Fatalities Per 100,000 Population in 2022



**Oklahoma excluded because complete data was not available*
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Infographics Available for Download

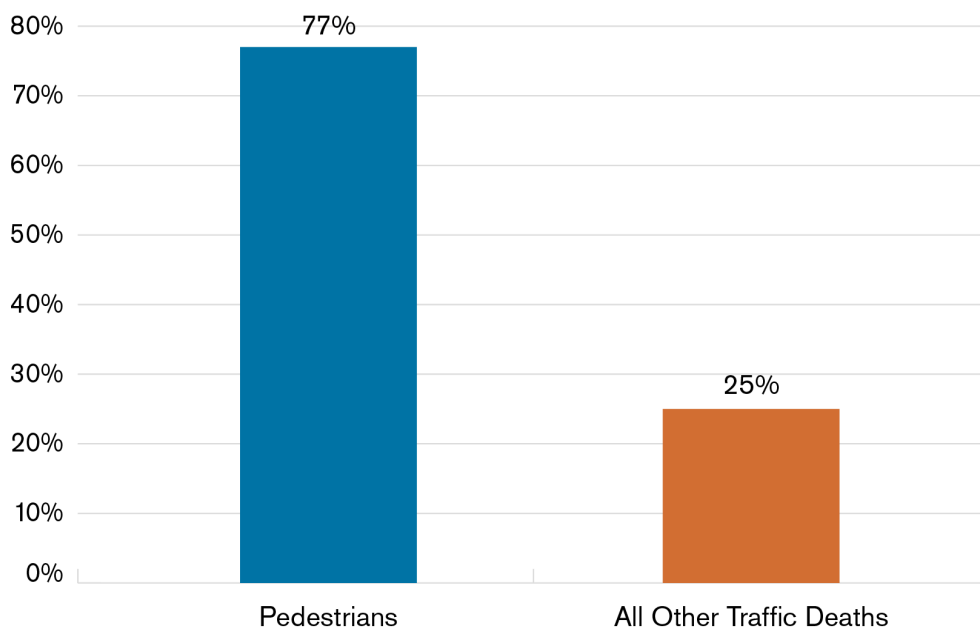
Please cite the Governors Highway Safety Association when using the graphics below. Right click on each graphic, then select "save image as..." to download it. If you're sharing on social media, consider tagging us at [@ghsahq](#) on X/Twitter, [@GHSAhq](#) on Facebook and [Governors Highway Safety Association \(GHSA\)](#) on LinkedIn.

GHSA projects at least 7,508 pedestrians were killed in traffic crashes in 2022, continuing the upward trend in recent years. This would be the most pedestrian deaths since 1981.



Pedestrian Deaths Are Increasing Faster Than All Other Traffic Fatalities

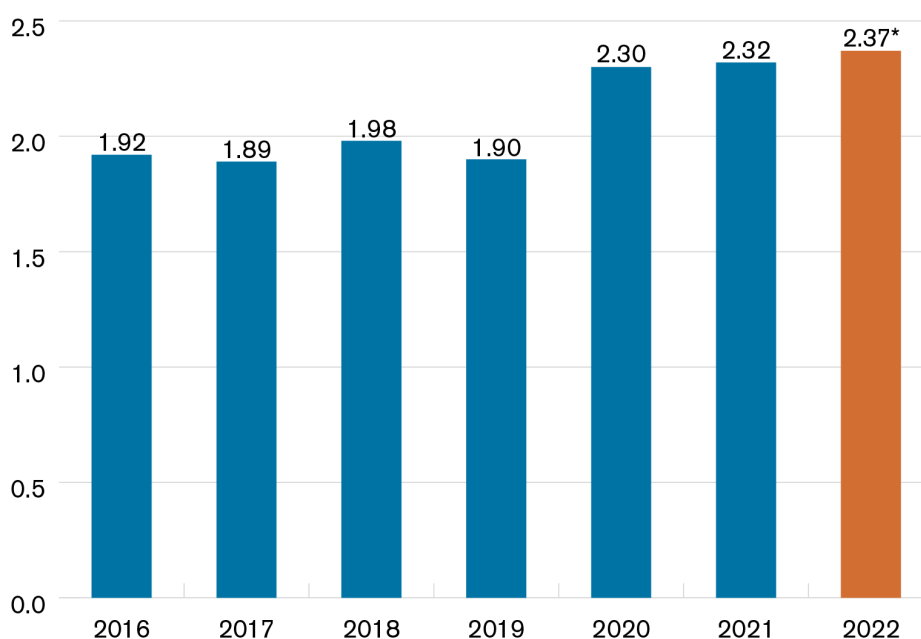
Percent Increase
in Number of
Traffic Deaths,
2010-2021



Pedestrian Fatality Rate Increased Yet Again in 2022

U.S. Pedestrian
Fatality Rate
per One
Billion VMT

* Projected



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SEPTEMBER 15, 2026

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Nine in ten parents also support automated stop-arm camera enforcement to prevent illegal school bus passings.

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NEWS RELEASES

AUGUST 27, 2026

Boldest, Most Innovative Roadway Safety Conference Yet Brings National Leaders Together in Minneapolis

GHSA's 2026 Annual Meeting spotlights the technology reshaping roadway safety, from AI to Intelligent Speed Assistance, in conversations that will move the needle.

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Pedestrian Traffic Fatalities by State

JANUARY - DECEMBER 2025
PRELIMINARY DATA

GHSA projects 6,732 pedestrian fatalities on U.S. roads in 2025 — down 7% from the year before.



GHSA REPORTS

JULY 14, 2026

Pedestrian Traffic Fatalities by State: 2025 Preliminary Data

GHSA projects drivers struck and killed 6,732 people walking in the United States in 2025, down 7% from the year before – the third straight annual decrease. Despite this progress, pedestrian deaths remain 5% above the pre-pandemic level.

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